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Summary By: Julia Dauksza | Published: September 12, 2018

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EXCLUSIVE EXTERNAL STUDY

This follow-up to Faunalytics' report on attitudes in the BRIC countries focuses specifically on demographic differences within China.

[此报告已由英文翻译成中文，请点击此处阅读报告的中文译文。
感谢Tipping Point Private Foundation对此项翻译工作的慷慨资助。]

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Faunalytics recently completed a cross-national comparative study of attitudes toward farmed anir and the BRIC countries: Brazil, Russia, India, and China.

A summary of the comparisons between the five countries is **available here**. This follow-up report p tables of results for China. It includes:

- **Tables 1-6:** An overall breakdown of survey responses for people from China (these can also be main report, but more detail is included here);
- **Tables 7-12:** A breakdown of survey responses for people from China by gender;
- **Tables 13-18:** A breakdown of survey responses for people from China by age; and
- **Tables 19-24:** A breakdown of survey responses for people from China by region.
- **Table 25:** Survey items in English and Chinese.

Some of the most noteworthy findings from the results for Chinese respondents include:

1. Chinese respondents were far more likely than respondents from any other country to choose r on the scales: In particular, for beliefs about animals, the perception of social norms, and the cc low meat prices and animal care. Of the smaller numbers who expressed an opinion, most tend pro-animal direction. (See main report for details comparing the countries.)
2. While the neutral option was still very common, pro-animal responses prevailed with respect tc about treating farm animals well—as was the case for all countries—and support for animal wel The latter received the most support in the North of China.
3. The older generation of Chinese respondents (aged 45+) has more favorable beliefs and attitu animals.
4. Unlike respondents from other countries, Chinese respondents' perceptions of social norms alig closely with their own attitudes. Respondents from all four of the other countries surveyed rate attitudes as more pro-animal than those of others. Speculatively, Chinese respondents may be perceive themselves as similar to their fellow citizens because of a greater emphasis on collect Chinese culture versus the cultures of Brazil, Russia, India, or the U.S. (**Hofstede, 1983**; **Hofstede 2018**). This possibility may be useful to advocates in that it suggests that influencing social nor attention to any pro-animal norm or trend) may be a particularly powerful strategy in China.

The study methodology is described in more detail in the main report. Data were collected in May a from an online representative sample of 1,001 Chinese respondents. The data were weighted to imp representativeness.

For the results by demographic group, it is important to remember that small differences between not meaningful, because they could occur by chance. Estimates of statistical significance—indicatin differences are large enough to be meaningful—are not provided in this report.

In each demographic section, we provide a rule of thumb for interpreting which differences are mea should be sufficient for most purposes. However, if exact information about significance is required Faunalytics.

Participants were presented with nine survey items as part of this study. These items, which are sho and Chinese at the end of this report, were carefully designed, translated, back-translated, and chec speakers to maximize equivalence between countries and languages.

The tables below show the results for all Chinese respondents.

Table 1. Beliefs about Animal Suffering in China

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither Agree nor Disagree	Ag
Animals used for food have approximately the same ability to feel pain and discomfort as humans.	2%	10%	50%	32
Eating meat directly contributes to the suffering of animals.	4%	19%	45%	27

Table 2. Attitudes toward Farmed Animal Welfare in China

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither Agree nor Disagree	Ag
It is important to me that animals used for food are well cared for.	3%	8%	43%	39
Low meat prices are more important than the well-being of animals used for food.	5%	19%	56%	17

Table 3. Perceived Social Norms in China

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neither Agree nor Disagree	A
The typical Chinese person thinks it is important that animals used for food are well cared for.	3%	12%	46%	3
The typical Chinese person thinks that low meat prices are more important than the well-being of animals used for food.	5%	17%	54%	2

Table 4. Support for Welfare Reform in China

	Strongly Oppose	Oppose	Neither Oppose nor Support	Support	Stro Sup
To what extent would you oppose or support a law in China that would require animals used for food to be treated more humanely?	2%	5%	41%	37%	15%

Table 5. Diet in China

Which of the following types of food have you eaten in the past year? Please select all that apply.	
Chicken	86%
Turkey	10%
Pork	90%
Beef	83%
Fish	85%
Other seafood (e.g., shrimp, crab)	66%
Other meat	28%
Insects	4%
Dairy products	76%
Eggs	81%
Vegetarian (including vegan)*	1%

*Vegetarian is defined as people who did not select any options but dairy and/or eggs. Vegan is defined as people who the above." The proportions of vegans for most countries are too small to reliably estimate separately.

Table 6. Diet Change in China

	A lot less meat	A little less meat	Same amount	A little more meat	A lo mo me
In the past three months (i.e., since March 2018), have you eaten more or less meat than you usually do (including chicken, turkey, pork, beef, fish, seafood, and other meats)?	5%	24%	44%	21%	5%

The tables below show the results for Chinese respondents by gender. Note that small differences b and women's responses may not be meaningfully different. In particular, differences of less than 5% chance.

Table 7. Beliefs about Animal Suffering by Gender (China)

	Male	Female
Animals used for food have approximately the same ability to feel pain and discomfort as humans.		
Agree	37%	38%
Neither agree nor disagree	49%	53%
Disagree	15%	9%
Eating meat directly contributes to the suffering of animals.		
Agree	31%	32%
Neither agree nor disagree	43%	48%
Disagree	26%	20%

Table 8. Attitudes toward Farmed Animal Welfare by Gender (China

	Male	Female
It is important to me that animals used for food are well cared for.		
Agree	45%	49%
Neither agree nor disagree	43%	44%
Disagree	13%	7%
Low meat prices are more important than the well-being of animals used for food.		
Agree	23%	17%
Neither agree nor disagree	55%	58%
Disagree	23%	25%

Table 9. Perceived Social Norms by Gender (China)

	Male	Female
The typical Chinese person thinks it is important that animals used for food are well cared for.		
Agree	37%	41%
Neither agree nor disagree	46%	46%
Disagree	17%	13%
The typical Chinese person thinks it is important that animals used for food are well cared for.		
Agree	28%	21%
Neither agree nor disagree	49%	59%
Disagree	23%	20%

Table 10. Support for Welfare Reform by Gender (China)

	Male	Female
To what extent would you oppose or support a law in China that would require animals used for food to be treated mo		
Support	48%	54%
Neither oppose nor support	43%	38%
Oppose	8%	6%

Table 11. Diet in the Past Year by Gender (China)

	Male	Fema
Which of the following types of food have you eaten in the past year? Please select all that apply.		
Chicken	85%	89%
Turkey	11%	9%
Pork	90%	89%
Beef	84%	82%
Fish	82%	89%
Other seafood (e.g., shrimp, crab)	62%	71%
Other meat	30%	27%
Insects	5%	4%
Dairy products	72%	81%
Eggs	77%	85%
Vegetarian (including vegan)*	2%	1%

*Vegetarian is defined as people who did not select any options but dairy and/or eggs. Vegan is defined as people who the above." The proportions of vegans for most countries are too small to reliably estimate separately.

Table 12. Diet Change in the Last Three Months by Gender (China)

	Male	Female
In the past three months (i.e., since March 2018), have you eaten more or less meat than you usually do (including cl pork, beef, fish, seafood, and other meats)?		
Eating more meat	27%	25%
Same amount	47%	40%
Eating less meat	25%	33%

The tables below show the results for Chinese respondents by age group. Note that small differenc groups' responses may not be meaningfully different. In particular, differences of less than 10% may chance.

There were fewer than 50 respondents aged 55+, so that age group is excluded from the tables. Su sample does not represent a wide enough cross-section of the population to be considered statisti

Table 13. Beliefs about Animal Suffering by Age (China)

	18-24	25-34	35-44
Animals used for food have approximately the same ability to feel pain and discomfort as humans.			
Agree	33%	34%	42%
Neither agree nor disagree	53%	53%	48%
Disagree	14%	13%	10%
Eating meat directly contributes to the suffering of animals.			
Agree	27%	28%	34%
Neither agree nor disagree	49%	46%	47%
Disagree	24%	26%	19%

Table 14. Attitudes toward Farmed Animal Welfare by Age (China)

	18-24	25-34	35-44
It is important to me that animals used for food are well cared for.			
Agree	41%	42%	49%
Neither agree nor disagree	47%	46%	44%
Disagree	12%	12%	7%
Low meat prices are more important than the well-being of animals used for food.			
Agree	15%	19%	22%
Neither agree nor disagree	63%	56%	58%
Disagree	23%	25%	20%

Table 15. Perceived Social Norms in Country by Age (China)

	18-24	25-34	35-44
The typical Chinese person thinks it is important that animals used for food are well cared for.			
Agree	35%	34%	44%
Neither agree nor disagree	52%	48%	42%
Disagree	14%	18%	13%
The typical Chinese person thinks that low meat prices are more important than the well-being of animals used for foo			
Agree	17%	24%	30%
Neither agree nor disagree	63%	53%	47%
Disagree	20%	23%	23%

Table 16. Support for Welfare Reform by Age (China)

	18-24	25-34	35-44
To what extent would you oppose or support a law in China that would require animals used for food to be treated mo			
Support	48%	46%	56%
Neither oppose nor support	44%	45%	37%
Oppose	7%	7%	8%

Table 17. Diet in the Past Year by Age (China)

	18-24	25-34	35-44
Which of the following types of food have you eaten in the past year? Please select all that apply.			
Chicken	90%	86%	84%
Turkey	10%	13%	9%
Pork	89%	88%	90%
Beef	82%	85%	82%
Fish	82%	87%	84%
Other seafood (e.g., shrimp, crab)	65%	70%	62%
Other meat	31%	30%	24%
Insects	4%	5%	4%
Dairy products	74%	73%	79%
Eggs	77%	79%	84%
Vegetarian (including vegan)*	1%	1%	2%

*Vegetarian is defined as people who did not select any options but dairy and/or eggs. Vegan is defined as people who the above." The proportions of vegans for most countries are too small to reliably estimate separately.

Table 18. Diet Change in the Last Three Months by Age (China)

	18-24	25-34	35-44	4
In the past three months (i.e., since March 2018), have you eaten more or less meat than you usually do (including cl pork, beef, fish, seafood, and other meats)?				
Eating more meat	33%	31%	20%	1
Same amount	37%	43%	50%	4
Eating less meat	29%	26%	27%	3

The tables below show the results for Chinese respondents by region. Note that small differences b responses may not be meaningfully different. In particular, differences of less than 10% may be due

There were fewer than 50 respondents from the West of China so that region is excluded from the t small sample does not represent a wide enough cross-section of the population to be considered s reliable.

Table 19. Beliefs about Animal Suffering by Region (China)

	North & North Eastern	Eastern	Southern
Animals used for food have approximately the same ability to feel pain and discomfort as humans.			
Agree	39%	39%	29%
Neither agree nor disagree	49%	51%	57%
Disagree	13%	10%	14%
Eating meat directly contributes to the suffering of animals.			
Agree	35%	29%	28%
Neither agree nor disagree	44%	45%	49%
Disagree	21%	26%	23%

Table 20. Attitudes toward Farmed Animal Welfare by Region (Chir

	North & North Eastern	Eastern	Southern
It is important to me that animals used for food are well cared for.			
Agree	53%	48%	45%
Neither agree nor disagree	36%	43%	45%
Disagree	10%	9%	10%
Low meat prices are more important than the well-being of animals used for food.			
Agree	20%	26%	22%
Neither agree nor disagree	52%	53%	58%
Disagree	28%	21%	20%

Table 21. Perceived Social Norms in Country by Region (China)

	North & North Eastern	Eastern	Southern
The typical Chinese person thinks it is important that animals used for food are well cared for.			
Agree	45%	44%	37%
Neither agree nor disagree	43%	44%	44%
Disagree	12%	12%	18%
The typical Chinese person thinks that low meat prices are more important than the well-being of animals used for f			
Agree	23%	29%	22%
Neither agree nor disagree	55%	52%	53%
Disagree	22%	20%	24%

Table 22. Support for Welfare Reform by Region (China)

	North & North Eastern	Eastern	Southern
To what extent would you oppose or support a law in China that would require animals used for food to be treated mo			
Support	57%	51%	46%
Neither oppose nor support	36%	41%	43%
Oppose	6%	8%	9%

Table 23. Diet in the Past Year by Region (China)

	North & North Eastern	Eastern	Southern
Which of the following types of food have you eaten in the past year? Please select all that apply.			
Chicken	87%	90%	89%
Turkey	8%	9%	13%
Pork	92%	91%	89%
Beef	79%	84%	83%
Fish	86%	87%	87%
Other seafood (e.g., shrimp, crab)	65%	73%	71%
Other meat	24%	30%	34%
Insects	7%	5%	3%
Dairy products	78%	78%	73%
Eggs	83%	83%	77%
Vegetarian (including vegan)*	1%	1%	1%

*Vegetarian is defined as people who did not select any options but dairy and/or eggs. Vegan is defined as people who the above." The proportions of vegans for most countries are too small to reliably estimate separately.

Table 24. Diet Change in the Last Three Months by Region (China)

	North & North Eastern	Eastern	Southern
In the past three months (i.e., since March 2018), have you eaten more or less meat than you usually do (including cl pork, beef, fish, seafood, and other meats)?			
Eating more meat	24%	30%	28%
Same amount	46%	45%	42%
Eating less meat	29%	24%	28%

The table below shows the nine items included in the survey as they were written in Chinese.

Table 25. Survey Items in English and Chinese

English	Chinese
To what extent do you agree or disagree with each of the following statements: Strongly disagree Disagree Neither agree nor disagree Agree Strongly agree	对于以下说法，您会在多大程度上表 强烈反对 反对 说不上同意还是反对 同意 强烈同意
Animals used for food have approximately the same ability to feel pain and discomfort as humans.	食用动物感受痛苦和不适的能力与人
Eating meat directly contributes to the suffering of animals.	吃肉会直接增加动物的痛苦。
It is important to me that animals used for food are well cared for.	对我而言，好好照顾食用动物非常重
Low meat prices are more important than the well-being of animals used for food.	低肉价比食用动物的康乐更加重要。
The typical Chinese person thinks it is important that animals used for food are well cared for.	典型的中国人认为，好好照顾食用动
The typical Chinese person thinks that low meat prices are more important than the well-being of animals used for food.	典型的中国人认为，低肉价比食用动 要。
To what extent would you oppose or support a law in China that would require animals used for food to be treated more humanely? Strongly oppose Oppose Neither oppose nor support Support Strongly support Don't know	如果政府在法律上，要求更加人道地 会在多大程度上表示反对或支持? 强烈反对 反对 谈不上反对还是支持 支持 强烈支持 不知道
Which of the following types of food have you eaten in the past year? Please select all that apply. Chicken Turkey Pork Beef Fish Other seafood (e.g., shrimp, crab) Other meat Insects Dairy products Eggs None of the above	过去一年来，您吃过以下哪类食物？ 项。 鸡肉 火鸡 猪肉 牛肉 鱼 其他海鲜（例如虾、螃蟹） 其他肉类 昆虫 奶制品 蛋类 以上都没有
In the past three months (i.e., since March 2018), have you eaten more or less meat than you usually do (including chicken, turkey, pork, beef, fish, seafood, and other meats)? A **lot** more meat A **little** more meat Same amount A **little** less meat A **lot** less meat Not applicable – I do not eat any meat	过去三个月来（即 2018年3月以来）， （包括鸡肉、火鸡、猪肉、牛肉、鱼 类）吃得多还是少? 多**很多** 多**一点** 一样多 少**一点** 少**很多** 不适用 – 我不吃肉

Meet the Author: Julia Dauksza

Julia Dauksza is Faunalytics' Research Assistant, and has a long history of supporting advocates and journalists addressing animal welfare and environmental issues, with data analysis and investigations. She has experience working for both the market research sector in her professional life, and years of volunteering in animal advocacy as a co-founder of Open Cages, the largest farmed animal advocacy organization in Eastern Europe. She is currently a student in her final year of Management with a specialization in Media & Business Sociology.

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A **Anders Kuvaas Herting**

6 years ago edited

I enjoyed reading this and the other reports from the BRIC-study. I think this is really well done, and I love that you present it in a bried and accessible way.

I had one thought about the Chinese respondents' tendency to give more neutral responses: Several studies suggest that East-Asian's tend to respond neutrally to rating scales in general. I think this has to do with social norms against standing out from the crowd.

Maybe it could be more interesting to look at the skew of the distribution of responses than at the percentage who chose "agree"? (I'm no data scientist). I think it also could be more interesting to look at behavior, e.g. consumer behavior—do people buy products marketed as "humane"? etc.—but that would, of course, be an entirely different study.

0 0 Reply

Faunalytics Mod → Anders Kuvaas Herting

6 years ago

Thanks very much for your comment, **@Anders Kuvaas Herting**! We were aware of the studies you mention, and indeed we had meant to discuss and cite in the study. It's unlikely we will do further re-analysis on this study as it's now over two years past, but we will keep this in mind as we do plan to do further study on these dynamics in China.

0 0 Reply

RL **Rosa Luo**

7 years ago

Hi, I read the analysis, and I am particularly interested in the detailed results in China . I am a biostatistician working in the US, while I was born and grew up in China until I finished my college. One thing that I would like to point out is: it would add more insight if the birth place of the respondents -- metropolitan area or rural area -- were used for analysis. These two locations tells a lot of a person's education, impact from family/community traditions, etc. Because of the "Hukou" system in China, the birth place is usually where the person receives early education (family education, elementary, middle school, and/or high school), which mainly forms the person's value and attitude. Also because of the uneven development in China, young people who grow up in rural area with less developed economic commonly

immigrate and look for jobs in more developed metropolitan areas. So when you survey adults in more developed eastern or southern metropolitan areas in China, the respondents within the same city could be from all over China but with so different background: education level, social-economic status, and values inherited from the family. I anticipate that you would see some associations between the attitudes and the birth places, and I believe these two locations would be so different in the methods of doing animal welfare advocacy in China.

1 0 Reply

J

Jo Rosa Luo

7 years ago

Thanks for the comment, Rosa! That is great information to know. Unfortunately we didn't collect any data on birthplace in this study, but this sounds like a valuable tip for future research. Especially given the difficulty of surveying people in rural China, if this would provide a means of accessing some who are at least FROM rural China, that could be a big help. Thank you very much!

0 0 Reply

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